CABANA FEET

2025 Fall PLP Case Study



MEET THE TEAM



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Co-Lead, Branding Specialist



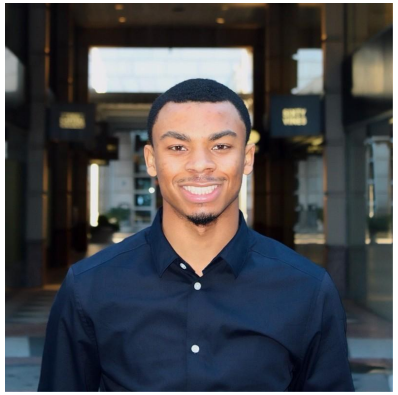
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Co-Lead, People and Forecasting Specialist



Chizaram Nwaka

Financial Specialist



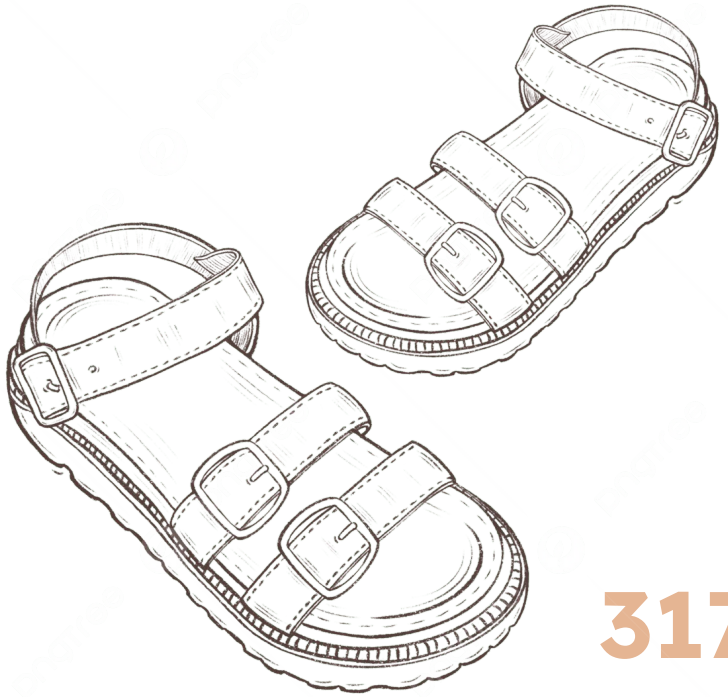
Nicolas Williams

Risk Management Specialist



Nhi Nguyen

Supply + Technical Implementation Specialist



PROBLEM

317% increase in demand

24% orders being met

How do we scale, both meeting demands of the time and staying true to our roots?

Current State Analysis

Shifts

1 shift
10 workers x $10/hr
1 supervisor x $20/hr
8 hrs/shift
20 work days/month

Production rate ≠ demand

Options

Hire more workers ✓

Increase shifts or hours ✓

Outsource ✗



Automate ✓

GOALS

Increase efficiency

Maintain brand image and loyalty

Sustainable expansion

AGENDA

- Automation
- Workforce Investment
- Brand Solution



Automation

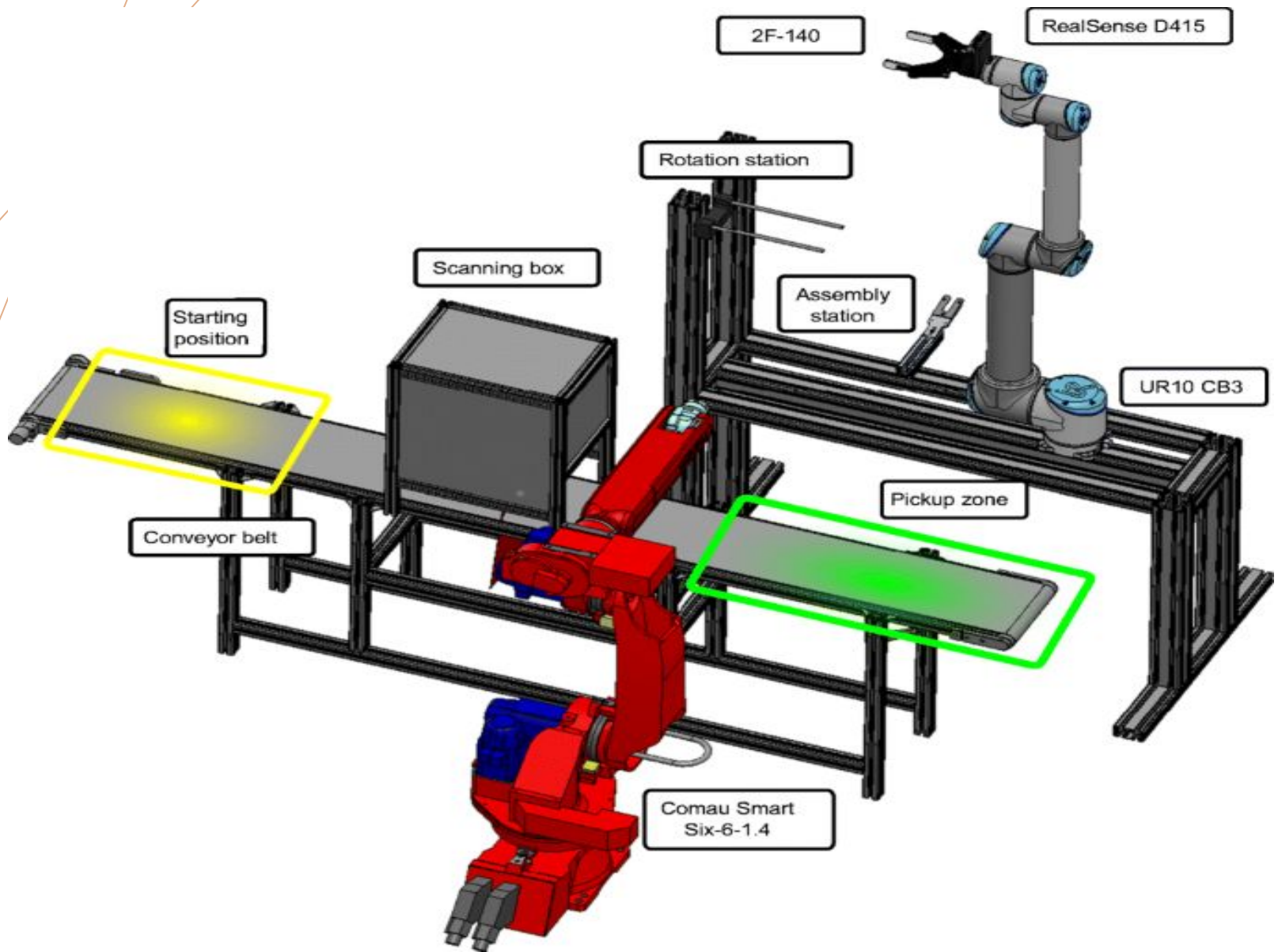
Why This Works:

Increase efficiency

Sustainable expansion


KUKA
Collaborative robot
Robotic Gluing

- **Task Automated**



✅Integrated RGB-D vision to handle variable sole shapes/ colors.

✅Precision gel dispensing & sole gluing.

✅Strap placement & riveting.

Employee roles: feeding material, final assembly, quality inspection, and co-bot oversight.



🚩 Preserve "Made in USA" brand using hybrid automation.

🚩 Scale to 25,000+ pairs/month with just 15 workers: 5x output using only 50% more labor, full quality consistency.



Workforce Investment

Why This Works:

- Increase efficiency
- Maintain brand image and loyalty
- Sustainable expansion

Workforce Investment

01	**Hire night shift**	• Allow for maintenance and continuity • Increase production in short term • Incentivize workers and new hires
02	**Different positions**	• Labor required to program and maintain machinery, perform quality control, and monitor production
03	**Transfer program**	• Maintain employee loyalty by shifting factory line workers, with company knowledge, to specialized and supervisory positions • Decreases culture gap

Workforce Investment

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[illegible]gram	• Maintain employee loyalty by shifting factory line workers, with company knowledge, to specialized and supervisory positions • Decreases culture gap

Balance hiring to meet immediate demand needs with change management of transfer program

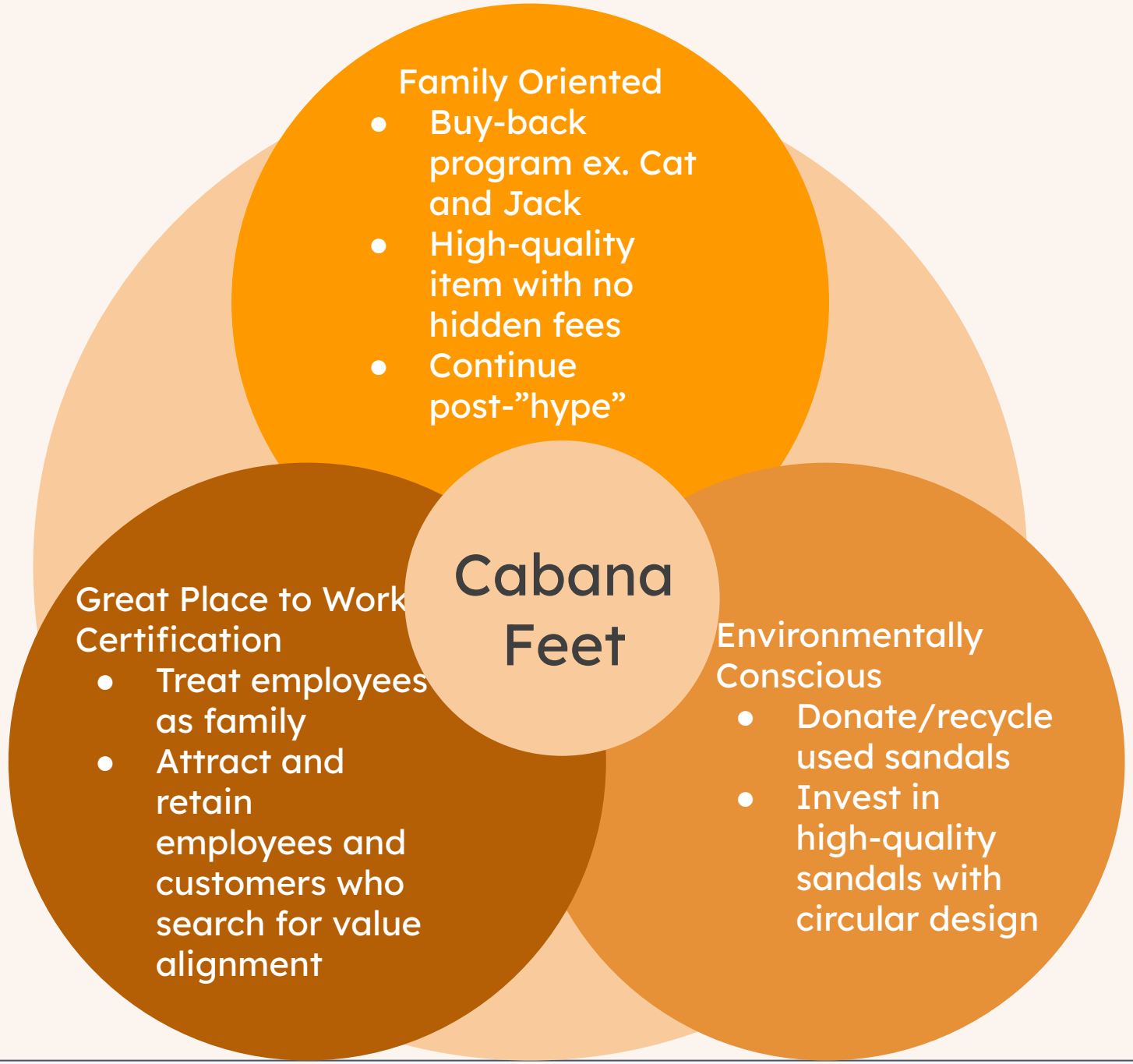


Brand Solution

Why This Works:

Maintain brand image and loyalty

Sustainable expansion


Family Oriented
Buy-back program ex. Cat and Jack
High-quality item with no hidden fees
Continue post-”hype”
Great Place to Work Certification
Treat employees as family
Attract and retain employees and customers who search for value alignment
Cabana Feet
Environmentally Conscious
Donate/recycle used sandals
Invest in high-quality sandals with circular design

MOONSHOT

Company Buy-Out

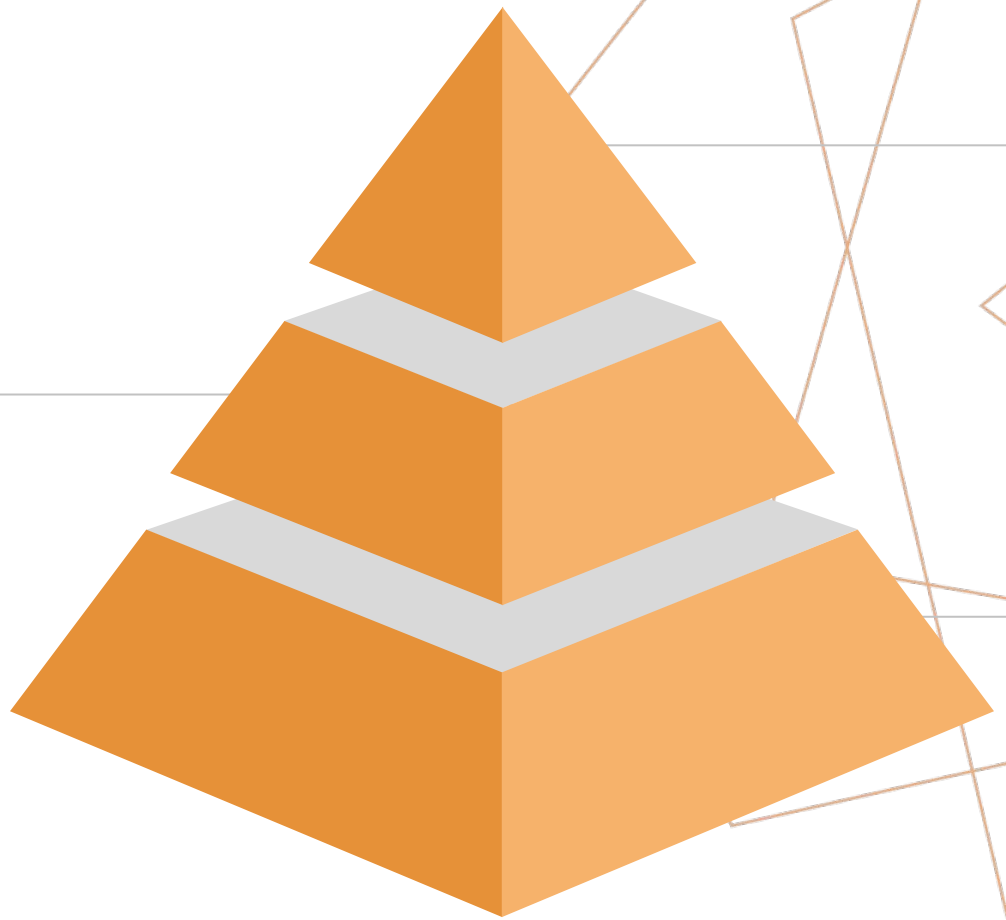
- Sustainable expansion and technological pace-keeping will position for buy-out

1

Increase Efficiency and Expand

- Once short-term demand is managed, smooth out and follow through on long-term plans

2



3

AI-Powered Solutions

- Collect historical data
- Implement AI-powered forecasting to prevent future production issues
- Optimize worker schedule and machinery function according to projected needs

CHALLENGES & MITIGATION

INTERNAL CHANGE MANAGEMENT

- Retain current employees in supervisory roles
- Increase cross-shift communication and production dashboards
- Incremental shift to automation
- Invest in contingency plans
- Ensure strong contracts with leasing company and experts to assist with maintenance
- Ensure employee feedback is sought out

OFF-SEASON

- Use “hype” to promote internationally
- Shift production volume
- Implement seasonal hiring
- Research into a winter-compatible product
- Discounts

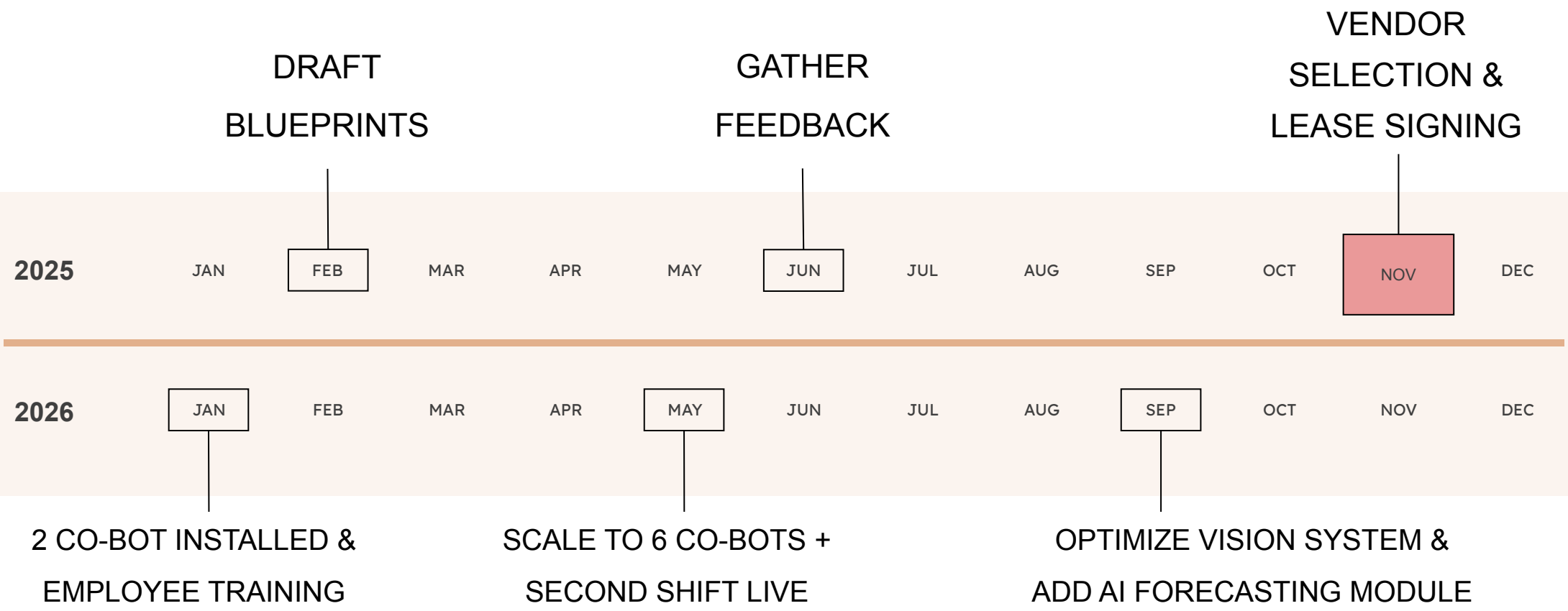
FINANCIALS & ROI

- Constant KPI tracking
- Ensure manageable leasing periods

REPUTATION

- Get ahead of the press with marketing
- Introduce flagship product
- Ensure anchor elements from brand - gel insole, made in USA
- Transparent practices and communication

IMPLEMENTATION



Financials

Grants & Funding Inputs

- Local & state innovation grants
- Funding for automation & training
- Reduces upfront equipment costs

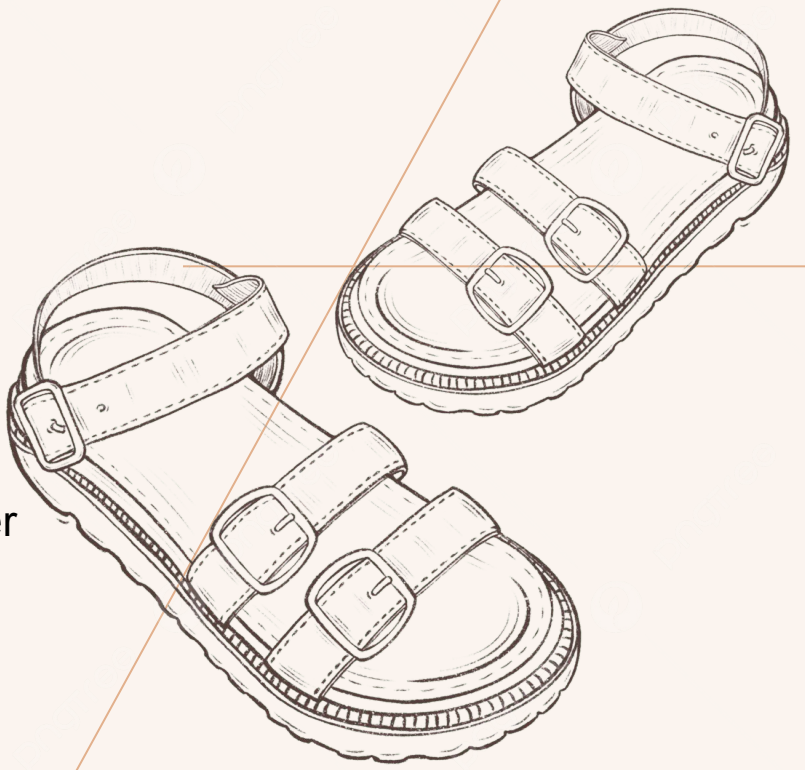
Operational Inputs

- Reinvestment of early sales
- Materials & production needs
- Retail partnerships for distribution

Business Output

- Increased production capacity
- New winter-ready sandal line
- Stronger employee retention
- Foundation for second facility

PROJECTED BENEFITS



- **Increased Production Output** – Measure units produced per day after automation.
- **Seasonal Revenue Growth** – Track sales increase from new winter sandal line.
- **Cost Efficiency** – Reduction in labor + production costs from automation.
- **Employee Retention Rate** – Higher retention due to stock-option program and team incentives.
- **Market Expansion** – Number of new retail partnerships and distribution locations.

CONCLUSION

Through hybrid automation, we reach our goal that Cabana Feet will sustainably meet surging demand while strengthening employee loyalty, preserving its “Made in USA” family values, and protecting the brand soul that customers love.